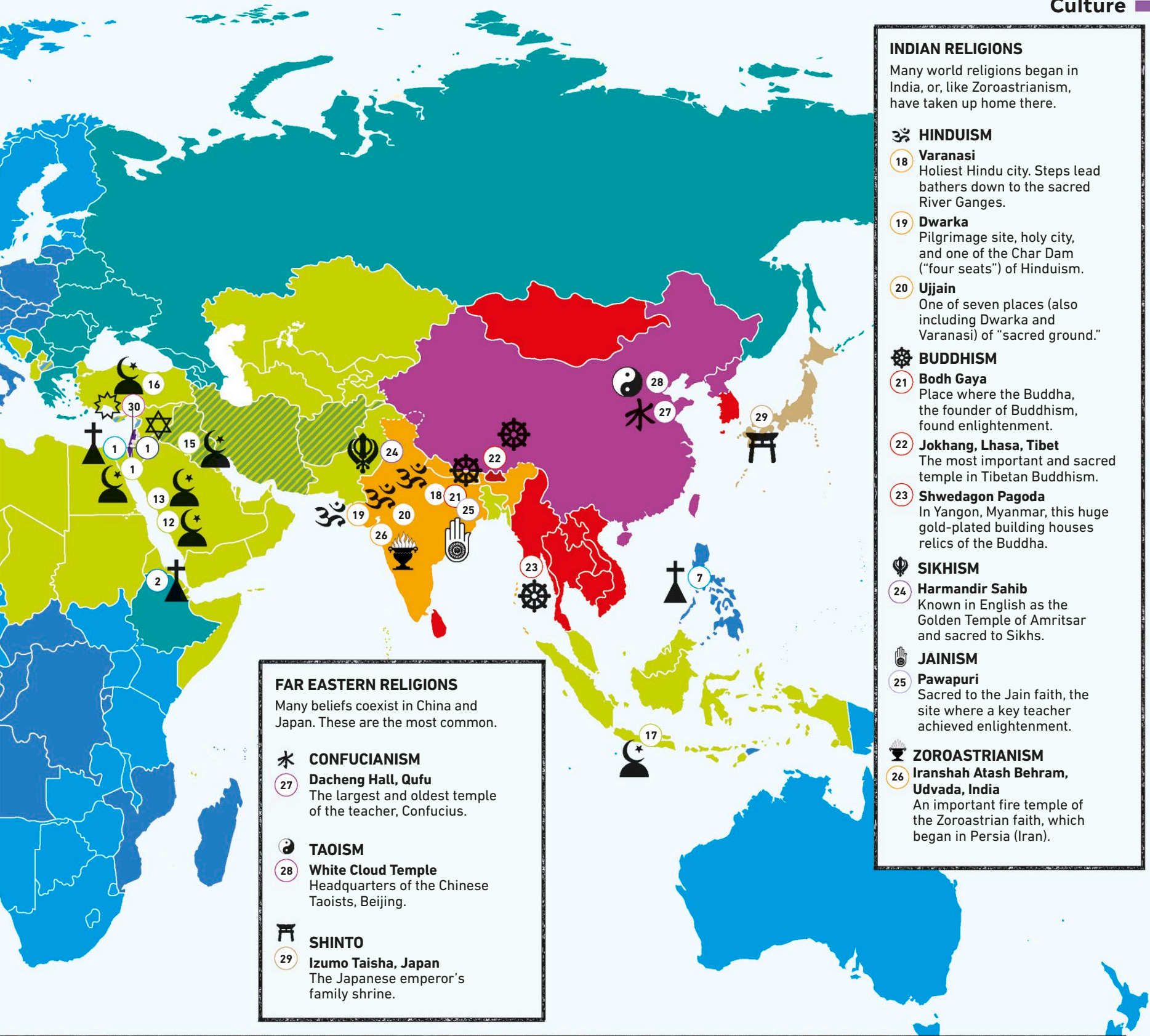




FAR EASTERN RELIGIONS

Many beliefs coexist in China and Japan. These are the most common.



CONFUCIANISM

- 27 **Dacheng Hall, Qufu**
The largest and oldest temple of the teacher, Confucius.



TAOISM

- 28 **White Cloud Temple**
Headquarters of the Chinese Taoists, Beijing.



SHINTO

- 29 **Izumo Taisha, Japan**
The Japanese emperor's family shrine.

INDIAN RELIGIONS

Many world religions began in India, or, like Zoroastrianism, have taken up home there.

HINDUISM

- 18 **Varanasi**
Holiest Hindu city. Steps lead bathers down to the sacred River Ganges.
- 19 **Dwarka**
Pilgrimage site, holy city, and one of the Char Dam ("four seats") of Hinduism.
- 20 **Ujjain**
One of seven places (also including Dwarka and Varanasi) of "sacred ground."

BUDDHISM

- 21 **Bodh Gaya**
Place where the Buddha, the founder of Buddhism, found enlightenment.
- 22 **Jokhang, Lhasa, Tibet**
The most important and sacred temple in Tibetan Buddhism.
- 23 **Shwedagon Pagoda**
In Yangon, Myanmar, this huge gold-plated building houses relics of the Buddha.

SIKHISM

- 24 **Harmandir Sahib**
Known in English as the Golden Temple of Amritsar and sacred to Sikhs.

JAINISM

- 25 **Pawapuri**
Sacred to the Jain faith, the site where a key teacher achieved enlightenment.

ZOROASTRIANISM

- 26 **Iranshah Atash Behram, Udvada, India**
An important fire temple of the Zoroastrian faith, which began in Persia (Iran).

- 6 **Our Lady of Aparecida, São Paulo, Brazil**
Eight million Catholic pilgrims a year visit this celebrated statue of the Virgin Mary.

- 7 **San Agustin Church, Manila**
The Philippines' oldest church, dating from 1607.

- 8 **All Saint's Church, Germany**
In Wittenberg, Martin Luther began Protestantism by nailing his ideas on the church door.

- 9 **Canterbury Cathedral**
Place of pilgrimage and world center of the Anglican Protestant Church.

- 10 **St. Peter's Church**
The oldest Anglican church outside Britain, in Bermuda.

- 11 **Salt Lake Temple**
Largest center of worship of the Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints, known as the Mormon Church.

ISLAM

Muslims, followers of Islam, believe in one god and that Muhammad (570–632 CE) is His prophet. This religion split into Sunni and Shi'a faiths early on.

- 12 **Makkah**
Sacred to all Muslims as Muhammad's birthplace.

- 13 **Medinah**
The burial site of Islam's prophet, Muhammad.

- 14 **Kairouan, Tunisia**
Fourth city of Sunni Islam, and seat of Islamic learning.

- 15 **Najaf, Iraq**
Third city of Shi'a Muslims. Features the tomb of their first imam, Imam Ali.

- 16 **Konya, Turkey**
Home of Sufi mystic Rumi, whose followers perform the "Whirling Dervish" dance.

- 17 **Demak Great Mosque**
One of Indonesia's oldest mosques, built in the 15th century.